

Grounding Skills

Greater Nashua Mental Health Center

Instructions: Grounding skills bring you back to the present moment during flashbacks, dissociation, panic, or overwhelming urges. They work by anchoring attention in the senses and the here-and-now. Practice them when calm so they're available in distress.

5-4-3-2-1 sensory grounding

Name them out loud or write them down:

5 things I can SEE

4 things I can FEEL / TOUCH

3 things I can HEAR

2 things I can SMELL

1 thing I can TASTE

More grounding tools

- | | |
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| ☐ Hold something cold or textured | ☐ Name today's date, place, and your age aloud |
| ☐ Press feet firmly into the floor | ☐ Sip cold water slowly |
| ☐ Describe an object in detail | ☐ Count backward from 100 by 7s |
| ☐ Notice 5 colors in the room | ☐ Stretch and feel your muscles |

Which grounding tools work best for me, and where will I keep this list?